



MONTHLY UPDATE

Digital Identity and CRVS: monthly update, July 2026

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40 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The unified national digital identity is being used as a single sign-on, and the record's first evidence of that is a sectoral one. On 12 August the sports ministry [integrated its platforms into the national services portal so that holders of the credential reach its WADHIFATI platform without registering again](#). The credential is issued by the Haut Commissariat a la Numerisation; no enrolment count, assurance level, governing instrument or data-protection basis for it is held, so what a reader can establish is that it works across two systems, not how many people hold it or on what legal footing.

Angola

On 28 July the justice ministry [launched an at-home service priced at Kz 250,000](#) for processing and Kz 10,000 for delivery alone, in one province only, the minister justifying the fee as a product of exclusivity.

The single digital identity, named as a workstream since 2024 and as [a component of the US\\$150m public digital infrastructure contract in June](#), acquired a price and a procurement. [Despacho Presidencial 300/26 of 13 August authorised US\\$28m and opened the public tender](#) for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to support up to 30 million digital identities and to let citizens, firms and public officials use one digital credential for public services, digital contracts, electronic verification of customers and legally valid electronic signatures. No supplier, timetable, or relationship to the earlier contract is stated.

Botswana

Two identity-layer systems showed capacity problems rather than design problems this month. The public accounts committee was told on 30 July that the [national public key infrastructure has P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, and no working system, timeline or accountable owner](#). On the committee's account Botswana has no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer. The ministry's own headline figure appears as both P420m and P423m in the single account.

On 28 July a parliamentary answer put identity-card replacement delays down to [too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns](#). The delays have run since the start of 2026 and the answer carries no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment.

Burkina Faso

The Council of Ministers of 30 July also [adopted the decree organising mass registration for the unique electronic identifier](#), through committees run entirely by public structures so that fingerprint and iris data stay in-country, with mass enrolment targeted before end-2026. Enrolment had not begun as at 5 August, and the decree states no target, budget or supervisory authority. A Nigerien technical mission was received on 30 July.

Burundi

Biometric civil registration is [operating in 13 pilot communes, decentralised to zone level and interoperable with health-facility birth and death records, with a national unique identifier planned on fingerprint and facial biometrics](#). The health-facility link is the part with numbers behind it: the interior ministry says it has been [piloted since 2023, institutionalised in 2024, and now runs in 123 health facilities where it has recorded more than 52,000 births](#). No coverage denominator is given for either figure.

It is being built onto a base that already reaches most children: [84% of under-fives are registered at birth and 66% hold a birth certificate](#), cited by government on Africa Civil Registration Day. The gap between the two figures is the one the platform has to close.

Cameroon

Two identity operations ran in the month, both municipal. On 27 July [4,000 free identity cards were handed over at Yaoundé 5](#), some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site; the operation was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. From 3 July, [compulsory registration of taxi owners and drivers opened on a city platform](#), with a QR code and a unique door number per driver and unregistered taxis barred after 5 October.

The register underneath both is only now being equipped. On 7 August the United Nations development programme [opened a tender for the equipment of three pilot centres digitising civil-status registration](#). Three centres is the whole of the stated scope, and the notice names neither their locations nor a value or timetable — against a paper record the base elsewhere shows being used to draw fraudulent payroll claims.

Cape Verde

The identity stack is unchanged and its next step is undated. The national identity card [keeps its design and legal basis and is now produced domestically and renewable online through the justice portal](#), and the [mobile digital key rests on implementing rules of 2022](#) with no activation count and no coverage rate held from any date. The authentication platform was [presented at the continental identity meeting with a stated next phase of consolidating](#)

[existing databases, expanding identity-enabled services and finding long-term financing models](#) — carrying no date, instrument or budget line. The restriction binding the mobile credential to prior card activation is undated on the government page and may no longer hold.

Congo

The same roadmap names [secure digital identity and a wallet among three digital public infrastructure foundations](#), with no standing-up instrument, budget or date.

Cote d'Ivoire

The identification office's director general [put national identification number holders at roughly 11 million](#) on 30 July and named historic duplicate identities inside the register — the disclosure, not the register, is what is new. The office trained sub-prefects on civil registration on 30 and 31 July, after registrars earlier that week.

Djibouti

Two interviews of 23 July 2026 put the identity stack on the record in detail. The Direction générale de la Population et de la Famille [enrols fingerprints, iris, photograph and electronic signature into the Registre national des personnes physiques and issues each citizen a national identification number](#); its director-general states the card has been issued nationwide since 2025 and that mobile kits reach the elderly, the hospitalised and remote populations. Automatic comparison against the national base is returning duplicate registrations, birth-date contradictions decades old, and people who have lived their administrative lives under a dead person's identity; those cases go to the parquet for judicial regularisation.

DR Congo

A sector chief in Walikale told the provincial interior division on 23 July that his civil-status office had [no birth registers for several months and had stopped registering newborns](#); the province promised resupply with no date, and the stated consequences are exclusion from school enrolment and from proof of nationality.

Egypt

Identity gained a second biometric front end and a liability problem in the same month. The central bank governor launched [Haweya, registering face and fingerprint biometrics and enabling remote account opening at 37 banks](#), and the [national identity application reached a second release adding liveness detection](#). Neither carries an enrolment count or a governing decree. Against that, the telecommunications regulator [stated that registration alone does not establish criminal liability](#) after lines were found registered to people without their knowledge, after reports of a nineteen-year-old sentenced in absentia to 25 years in a case turning on a line registered in his name in 2024; it says it is revising the rules towards biometric subscriber verification, with no date or target stated. Within a week the revision acquired shape: the regulator [tightened the registration rules, referred the four mobile operators to the prosecution and set a unified national digital-identity project alongside](#), and is [expanding mandatory facial verification at enrolment through its know-your-customer system, linked to the civil registry](#). Verification at

enrolment does not prevent a line being handed on afterwards, which is the gap the case turned on. The health ministry is separately [stated to have taken birth and death registration electronic nationwide](#), on the development plan's own word and with no coverage rate published.

Ethiopia

The identity programme supplied most of the month's movement: a [joint venture with Safaricom and a local partner](#) on 6 July to run mass registration across seven regions, and, on 24 July, the operator's own disclosure that it accounts for 69% of all registrations, with more than 4m farmers enrolled through the agriculture ministry and more than 28,000 displaced people through humanitarian partners.

At the same 24 July launch of a three-year strategic plan, its deputy director in the capital named premature integration as the year's main obstacle and its founding director general conceded the platform remains intertwined with decades-old institutional systems of undefined standards. The identity layer meanwhile acquired a corporate owner: the Faydaverse digital-public-infrastructure enterprise was inaugurated on 4 August as a state-owned enterprise under Ethiopian Investment Holdings, on a platform [reported at over 190 million authentications performed and 150 enterprises integrated for biometric checks](#). No governing instrument, board or commercial model for the enterprise is published.

Four days later that enterprise set out where the credential goes next. Its wallet is [to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and financial-compliance and know-your-customer data beyond the core government credentials it holds today](#), and the enterprise says it is exporting identity services as an implementation partner in Mozambique and Zambia. The plan and the export claims are its own; no timetable, consent model, data-controller arrangement or regulatory approval for the additional credential types is stated.

What is not on the record is the counterweight. A published critique argues the system [risks becoming an instrument of mass profiling in the absence of independent data-protection impact assessments, meaningful citizen rights and legal limits on state access](#), against 46.5m registrations by July 2026, up from 16.4m in June 2025, and a 90m target. The base holds no such assessment, no redress mechanism and no statutory access limit, and that absence is now recorded as a gap.

Gambia

The [National Identity Management System went live on 1 July 2026](#), issuing GAM ID cards on the spot, with nationwide enrolment from 4 August 2026. No enrolment or issuance figure has been published since, so its reach is unestablished.

Ghana

The identity regulator publicised amendment regulations on 16 July that had come into force on 9 June, and the interior minister then set the enforcement date: banks, telecoms operators, hospitals, schools, insurers and agencies have [a three-month transition from 27 July to 2 November 2026](#) to install readers and integrate with the verification service, on a sanctions ladder running to suspension of access and licence withdrawal. Verification tied to SIM registration is explicitly excluded, with no timetable announced.

The first paid round-the-clock identity centre opened on 1 August with all services attracting approved charges and no fee schedule published; by 13 August the agency described the Labone centre as [running registration on three shifts around the clock](#), presented as part of the government's wider 24-hour economy programme. No throughput or staffing figure is published, and the base holds no equivalent extension of the free daytime service.

Guinea

Four days later, Multimédia Glory Guinée — the state's own technical partner deploying the biometric civil-registration system — [stated publicly that fees not provided for in the regulations were being taken at enrolment centres, that a pay-for-priority tier operated, and that citizens were unaware the documents are free](#). It asked two ministries for unannounced inspections, sanctions, an information campaign and a reporting line; neither had responded at publication.

On 10 August the territorial administration minister [put birth registration at 72% in 2025 against 54% in 2022, and said a unique personal identification number was being put in place alongside digitalisation of the civil-status system](#). The figures are the minister's own, given at a commemorative event with no statistical source named, and the identification number still has no instrument, issuing authority, format or enrolment figure on record.

Kenya

Government is [procuring a system to cut identity-card issuance to ten days and passports to a week](#). The source is a headline account; no contract, vendor or value is held.

Two identity systems met the courts instead. The High Court [barred the transport authority from discontinuing physical vehicle logbooks](#) on 11 August, pending a petition arguing the electronic logbook was introduced without public participation and without adequate data-protection and cybersecurity impact assessments. Separately, the Attorney-General's six-month window to legislate on phone-number recycling, opened by the March judgment recognising a registered number as a protected digital identifier, [was still open in August with nothing tabled](#), while banks, savings societies and platforms continue to rely on numbers after reassignment.

Liberia

The identity build reached the legislature. The National Identification Registry says [procurement of an Austrian firm to build a new biometric identification system under a public-private partnership is complete, and the concession agreement is with the President ahead of legislative ratification](#); a day later, [consultations on the draft agreement had concluded and it had gone to Parliament for approval](#), with the registry stating it will disclose the terms only once ratification is complete and officials saying issuance will be free for poor first-time applicants. Mass enrolment has been suspended since 23 June 2025, so the country has been more than a year without one, and coverage stands [below 15% of a population above five million](#). No concession value, term, revenue model or data-protection provision is published.

A second identity register is being built outside the state entirely. On 16 August the commercial motorcycle and tricycle riders' union and a private digital services company [signed a memorandum to build a digital identity, GPS tracking and a rider database](#), aimed at curbing vehicle theft and linking informal-sector riders to formal financial and government services. It covers continuous location tracking of a working population, and no data-protection basis, custodian, retention rule or consent mechanism is reported for it.

Libya

The national digital identity's [biometric tier is in technical trials with the central bank and several banks, ahead of integration into banking know-your-customer checks](#). The [same system is named differently in the authority's own April and July releases](#), which is the only naming the base has for it.

Madagascar

On 27 July the interior ministry reviewed the first phase of adult biometric registration, reporting [more than six million people enrolled against a two-million target across April to June 2026](#). A second phase is in preparation, supported by the World Bank-financed DECIM project. No cost figure for either phase is reported.

Malawi

The registration bureau reported on 13 July 2026 that more than 13.5 million people hold a national digital identity, with over 150,000 enrolled between April and June, 53% of them women ([registration bureau](#)). On 6 July it named the forthcoming mobile credential and set its launch for September 2026 ([registration bureau](#)). On 5 August a separate blockchain-enabled wallet built by the United Nations Development Programme was stated to be in pilot ahead of nationwide rollout; neither announcement names the other.

Using the system got more expensive. The bureau [raised fees for national identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services](#) under the National Registration (Amendment) Regulations 2026, gazetted on 31 July. The individual fee levels and their previous values are not carried in the record held, so the size of the increase is not established — but the charge for electronic know-your-customer verification is a charge on third parties for using the identity system, levied in the same month the bureau reported approaching universal coverage.

Mali

On 21 July an editorial account [set out the E-AES passport's specification](#): five categories issued under the confederation dispositif, five years, 34 pages, biometrics on chip, to ICAO specification.

On 24 July the Council of Ministers [adopted a draft ordinance formalising the cahier de recensement](#), the village-level register from which family record books are issued, replacing Loi n06-023 of 28 June 2006.

Mauritius

The same omnibus also makes immigration permits issuable in digital form and imposes a digital travel authorisation on visa-exempt arrivals.

Morocco

The government council approved a draft decree on 9 July 2026 amending the 2008 biometric passport decree: four languages including Amazigh, an encrypted chip to international civil aviation standard, the holder's address removed from the biodata page and temporary passports abolished ([approval account](#)). Issuance is expected from August 2026, and the joint body that will set issuance procedures is not yet in place.

Mozambique

The identification directorate reported on 23 July that it produced 856,101 identity cards in the first half of 2026 on 813,307 applications, against 730,527 a year earlier, with 297,470 issued free ([directorate account](#)). On 28 July the President extended free issuance of the identity card, birth certificate and personal certificate to 2027, stating neither the end month nor the deadline it replaces ([presidential announcement](#)).

The humanitarian register moved from pilot to a dated launch. Validation of the beneficiary and humanitarian assistance management system [was completed with national launch stated for October 2026](#), the platform backed by the World Food Programme and built to interoperate with the national social-support database so that duplicate and fictitious beneficiary registrations can be curbed. No data-protection basis, retention rule or enrolment target is published.

Namibia

The identity ministry reported on 23 July that it printed 166,237 identity documents between 1 April 2025 and 30 June 2026 of which 125,999 were collected, leaving 40,238 uncollected, and that a school registration drive had reached 24 of 55 target schools ([ministry figures](#)).

The regional outreach opened in Omaheke on 27 July and ran to 5 August across all seven constituencies, delivered with a development agency and the regulator ([outreach account](#)). The regional governor said marginalised communities need to be convinced to take up the card, and the ministry team named low literacy as the obstacle to understanding it ([governor's account](#)).

Alongside the outreach runs a [Youth e-ID Ambassadors Programme, using young people to promote take-up of the credential and civic participation](#). Participant numbers, cost, duration and any effect on enrolment are unstated, and the funding agency's own account is the only one the base holds.

Niger

On 16 July the [president was the first enrollee for the AES biometric passport](#), a second phase after the identity card, in five categories — ordinary, service, diplomatic, refugee and Hadj — produced by the police security directorate with a Libyan supplier and a local partner; the [prime minister enrolled on 23 July](#).

On 27 July an account of the [restructured WURI-Niger project](#) set out the four instruments of April and May 2026 behind it — the civil-status ordonnance and its application décret, and the two décrets creating and chartering ANEI — and the three registers they establish, with population-register enrolment starting in Niamey's five arrondissements.

Nigeria

Identity gained infrastructure and kept its gap. The passport became [cryptographically verifiable at 111 member states' borders](#) on 16 July; the identity authority [took the national root certification authority over from NITDA](#) on 21 July; and [V-Pass went live](#) for airport security checks and boarding on the number and face biometrics. Registration stands at [136 million against a target of 180 million by 31 December](#), leaving about 100 million people uncaptured on the information minister's own figure. The root certification authority it took over also created a conflict: the NIMC Act 2026 makes the identity commission the root authority while the [still-pending Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill](#) carries its own electronic-signature provisions, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved.

Rwanda

The social registry has run an appeals process since it opened in early 2024, and [360,000 people challenged their category, with 93% of disputed classifications corrected](#). Disputes trace largely to stale asset records — unrecorded land or vehicle sales — and the correction rate is the social affairs directorate's own.

Senegal

Consolidated agency data at 17 July records [437 of 629 civil-status centres fully deployed, 112 of them running the citizen-facing service](#); on 13 July the agency reported [15.3m records loaded](#).

Deployment moved again in August, and the agency put a frame around it. At African Civil Registration Day in Kaolack on 10 August it [launched phase four of its remediation plan and put deployment at 74% of centres, up from 70% five days earlier, with the citizen request platform live in 189 communes](#), phase four extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda; its director-general described civil registration as an instrument of sovereignty.

Sierra Leone

Identity took three public positions in four days. MoCTI [convened a national dialogue on digital identity and digital public infrastructure on 5 August](#), describing it as the first of a series and as the beginning of the policy work rather than its result. A private-sector consultation the following day settled two specifications: the register being built on is [MOSIP-based, and the credentials envisaged under the Bhutan National Digital Identity and SIGN Foundation partnership are W3C-compliant verifiable credentials](#). On 7 August the NCRA Director-General told the consultation that [the biometric register already covers about 93% of the population with a unique National Identification Number and a live eKYC platform, and that the Authority's own MOSIP pilot is complete but unfunded for full implementation](#) — and warned against parallel identity systems being built alongside it.

In a 4 August ministerial statement responding to the mobile-money fraud surge, the communications minister [conceded the NIN-SIM linkage does not yet cover every subscriber](#).

Somalia

Cabinet [approved a third-generation e-passport plan on 6 August](#). No issuance date is published, and it follows the clearance in February to adopt and print the East African Community e-passport.

South Africa

Absa [joined the bank-branch smart identity channel](#), which the department put at 296 branches and more than 385,000 applications in four months; Operation Vulindlela's quarterly report [gave 203,887 applications across 171 branches](#). The reference periods differ and the figures have not been reconciled. Mobile operators and the justice department agreed a framework to [replace document presentation in SIM registration with real-time departmental verification](#). The base has since taken in a submission made on the closing day of the draft Identification Regulations' comment period on 6 June, in which a research organisation asked the department to suspend the regulations pending a published digital identity policy, an enacted National Identification and Registration Bill and demonstrated compliance with the data-protection Act, on the ground that they build biometric enrolment, trusted-entity accreditation and real-time verification with no formal role for the Information Regulator. The submission is held as a supplied document with no published address, so it cannot be linked to a reader.

On 29 July the Western Cape High Court [held four categories of exclusion in the birth-registration regulations unconstitutional](#), allowing 18 months for amendment and holding that the orders required no Constitutional Court confirmation.

Home Affairs reported that its electronic travel authorisation had [refused more than 5,500 travellers](#) since October 2025. It then left the pilot: the system [went live at OR Tambo, Cape Town, King Shaka and Lanseria from 12 August, with 6,126 fraudulent applications rejected — put at 2.8% of pilot submissions — and full visa-type rollout targeted by year-end](#). The department publishes no statistical series, and the four rejection counts it has given this year rest on bases that do not reconcile.

By mid-August the branch channel had a locator of its own. The department [launched a My Home Affairs Online portal on 17 August to help citizens find a participating branch, putting the network at 372 branches and more than half a million users to date](#), and framing it with the electronic travel authorisation as a building block of the national digital public infrastructure roadmap. Its own downtime statement a week earlier put the branch count above 408; the two are not reconciled. The travel authorisation itself [drew industry questions over its R500 fee and the adequacy of consultation](#) after its airport launch.

The draft digital-identity regulations drew their sharpest technical criticism yet. A published argument holds that they [under-specify verifier authentication, transparency about the purpose of a request, and enforcement of data minimisation](#), and urges binding rules requiring a requesting party to prove who it is, state why it is asking, and log every share — so that accountability falls on institutions rather than on the citizen who consented.

South Sudan

The World Bank published its ID4D country diagnostic on 22 July 2026, putting [close to 90% of the population without any government-recognised identification](#). It records that obtaining the Nationality Certificate, the prerequisite for the identity card, requires costly age assessments or blood tests and travel to centralised offices, so most people acquire neither.

On 28 July the civil-registry directorate's plan also included [a digital national identity card to be issued to every citizen aged 18 and over as the gateway to bank accounts](#), delivery running through the health, justice and interior ministries with unnamed partners. It is [stated as intent only](#): no law, budget, timetable, vendor or platform is named.

The directorate says a [new-generation passport will be introduced in August 2027](#), moving the holder's occupation off the printed page into the digital system; raising ordinary validity from five to ten years, and issuing the East African Community passport, would each require amending the passport act, and no legislative timetable is given. It also [received 37,500 further passport booklets, putting stock at enough to sustain issuance to December 2026](#) with processing at about three days, and in Greater Yei [over 4,000 national identity cards began being collected on 13 July](#).

The directorate changed hands on 9 August, and both officeholders put numbers on the record. The outgoing director [put stock at about 32,000 passport booklets and 172,000 national identity cards, alongside 100 new mobile registration kits, a Nairobi memorandum toward an integrated civil registration system, and adult passport validity extended to ten years](#) — claims made at his own handover about his own tenure. His successor [put annual applicants above one million and delays at about a month](#), pledging faster and corruption-free issuance.

The largest registration actually carried out in the window was not the state's. The migration agency ran a [biometric registration and re-registration exercise across the Malakal protection-of-civilians site, the Bulakat transit centre and the Bentiu displacement camp, serving about 160,000 people between April and June](#), and its community-feedback data records an 1,100% rise in queries over the quarter, driven almost entirely by that exercise. No data-controller arrangement, retention rule, consent record or relationship to the national identity system is stated for it.

Sudan

The national digital identity system acquired a use case that makes it consequential, and the consequence lands on bank accounts. On 12 August the central bank [ordered banks to suspend and freeze customer accounts not updated by 30 September](#), under anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing data-verification requirements. Five days later it [extended the deadline to the end of 2026 and named the rollout of the national digital identity system as the route by which customers are to update their data](#).

Bankers [backed the directive as necessary for the banking system's soundness while warning that freezing non-compliant accounts risks financial exclusion amid war-driven displacement and lost documentation](#). The directive text is not held; no count of accounts affected, no exception for displaced customers without documents and no appeal route is stated. Nor is any enrolment figure held for the identity system itself — so account continuity is being tied to a credential whose coverage is unmeasured, which is the exclusion risk the base recorded before it launched.

Tanzania

The identity register is the most heavily integrated rail the base holds anywhere, and its coverage is flat. [Over 138 public and private institutions are integrated across banking, insurance and social security](#) — the hardest adoption figure the base carries for any African identity-verification rail. Against that, the register stands at [26.4m registered](#),

22.3m numbers issued and 20.6m cards physically distributed, about 81% of eligible adults at December 2025: counts up, percentage flat to slightly down against a growing adult denominator. The gap between numbers issued and cards in citizens' hands is 1.7m, and it did not close over the period.

Tunisia

From 1 July 2026 the mobile identity became a condition of transacting with the state: the investment authority made it mandatory for all investment-project declarations.

The health identifier's provenance became public on 27 July 2026. A ministry adviser confirmed that the identifier built for Covid-19 vaccination, holding records of over 3 million childhood immunisations, was adopted as the national health identifier and bound to the national identity card, the social security number and school and university identifiers. Roughly 100,000 medical files had been linked. On protection of that linked dataset the ministry asserts only that data is stored confidentially and securely.

Uganda

The identity authority put its own constraint on the record on 7 August: it is operating at 70% of its approved workforce, with 25 districts served by a single member of staff and two board seats vacant. The figures were given to the internal affairs minister alongside a request for a permanent headquarters and additional wage funding.

Four days later the Auditor General's account of the same authority reached the press, and it puts a size on the consequence. As at late October 2025 17 million citizens were still awaiting national identity cards, only 0.2% of first-time applicants had been cleared for printing, the staff vacancy rate stood at 26% and identity renewal faced a UGX256.8bn funding shortfall — reported amid cross-district queue chaos over collection of new cards. The figures are ten months old at publication, and the authority publishes no current backlog series against which to test them.

Zambia

Nothing published in the window moves the identity position. The most recent enrolment statement remains about 1.5 million of about 20 million people, roughly 7.5%, restated on 27 July (switch account), and biometric card issuance remains deferred until after the 13 August election.

Zimbabwe

A deputy registrar general told a meeting of African registrars general on 24 July that electronic passport enrolment centres operate in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad, with seven-day issuance away from the capital (meeting account).

The registration end of the same estate is being rebuilt with donor money. Ten civil registry sub-offices across eight districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded project with UNICEF, to widen birth-registration access in underserved communities through mobile registration and outreach alongside existing water, sanitation and nutrition platforms. No value, timetable, district list or birth-registration baseline is stated, so there is nothing to measure the effect against.

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